

Miners At Tucson For Series

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TUCSON — Coach Andy Cohen brings his University of Texas at El Paso baseballers here this weekend for a three-game Western Athletic Conference series which wraps up the season for the Miners.

Cohen, hoping to salvage something from the numerous mistakes committed by his Miners at El Paso, plans to feed the Wildcats a steady diet of lefthanded pitching.

The Wildcats are expected to see the southpaw slants of Marc Bombard, Harry Milner and Lynn Hunt before the three-game set is concluded.

Cohen, of course, is hopeful his Miners can patch up a leaky defense which spelled disaster against the Wildcats at El Paso. Owning a one run lead in the top of the ninth with two out and one on, the Miners committed two costly errors which, as the result, brought on defeat.

Milner, perhaps, will go against the Wildcats in the opener Friday with Hunt and Bombard set for Saturday duty. Milner, 5-8, has an 3.80 earned run average. Bombard, the work horse of the staff this season, is 8-5 with a 4.62 ERA while Hunt is 2-6 with a 3.83 ERA.

As a team, the Miners are nitting .260 with third baseman Danny Blanco's .321 (20 runs batted in) representing the best hitting mark. Left fielder Rich Butler leads the Miners in RBI's, 28, and has five home runs to go with his .261 average.

Catcher Ron Hix is the home run leader (7) and has driven in 24 runs while batting .314.

Leading hitter on Cohen's team is Joe Donohue who has fashioned a .455 average while seeing limited action. John Miller, who was struck by a pitch at Tempe earlier this spring, has watched his once healthy batting average take a great nose dive.